system and access for the transport of goods from one point in India to another via Nepal. This discussion and India's strong views on certain conditions damaged the positive outcome of this meeting. There was at least three months' delay in the renewal of the treaty that had first been signed in 1950 and sent out a political signal that Nepal was totally dependent on India for its survival.

The Indian agency's view prevailed when the Maoists decided to abjure violence and enter electoral politics. Some Nepalese Maoists leaders were still among the R&AW's assets and this played a crucial role in the peace process and the safe arrival of the Maoist leadership in Kathmandu from their hiding places in the Terai region.

India had always enjoyed organic links with Nepal but changing global dynamics and the Chinese presence loosened India's grip on the Himalayan kingdom. The R&AW officer Di-wakar recalled that even when the US government wanted something to be conveyed to Nepal, their diplomats requested India to pass the message on. But by 2009, Nepal had became so indifferent to India that an officer from the MEA was forced to turn down a proposal from the US embassy that wanted to convey that Nepal must look for political consensus and accommodate all the parties making efforts to strengthen democracy. This, he said, was a sign that the anti-India stand in the Nepalese political class was seen as pro-Nepal, though they remain politically and economically dependent on India.

Diwakar said, 'On the government level, we had decided to not give any direct message to the Nepalese government. The truth is that the intelligence agency was no longer in the position to persuade and influence the Nepalese. The R&AW also doubted